

Q. I am new to Linux platform and dual boot is really a pain for me. Can you suggest some alternative?

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Through email

A. Dual boot will always be a pain as long as you are dependent on Microsoft's Windows for something or the other. If you completely shift to Linux, you will not have to reboot the complete system again and again to switch between operating systems. But if that is not possible, you can use any of the available desktop virtualisation software and install Linux as a guest operating system. The best part is that you can try as many different OS as you want without disturbing the host OS, which is Windows in your case. You do not even have to reboot your computer to move to Linux from Windows.

The most popular virtualisation software are VMware Player and Virtual Box (see Figs 1 and 2).

Mentioned below are the steps to install Linux in VMware Player:

1. Download VMware Player from <http://www.vmware.com/download/player/download.html> and install it
2. Run VMware Player and click 'Create a New Virtual Machine' under 'File' menu
3. Select 'Installer Disc Image (ISO)' and click 'Browse' to select the Linux ISO file, followed by 'Open' and then 'Next'
4. Now type in 'Full Name' and 'User Name', which must consist of only lowercase letters and password. After you finish, click 'Next'
5. Give your virtual machine a name and select an appropriate loca-



Fig. 1: VMware Player



Fig. 2: Virtual Box

tion to store the virtual machine by clicking 'Browse'. The partition should have at least 5GB free space

6. In 'Maximum Disk Size,' allocate disk space recommended for the corresponding OS
7. Select 'Store Virtual Disk As A Single File' for optimal performance and click 'Next'
8. Click 'Customize' and go to 'Memory' to allocate more RAM (1 GB will be okay)
9. Go to 'Processors' and select 'Number of Processors' — 1 for single-core, 2 for dual-core, 4 for quad-core and so on. This is to ensure optimal

performance of the virtual machine

10. Click 'Close,' then 'Finish' to start the Linux install process

The steps to install Linux in VirtualBox follow:

1. Download VirtualBox from <https://www.virtualbox.org/wiki/Downloads> and install it
2. Run VirtualBox and click 'New' to create a new virtual machine
3. Select a name for your virtual machine
4. Select 'Type' and 'Version' of the operating system you are trying to install and click 'Next'
5. Now select a RAM size for your virtual machine
6. On the next panel, select 'Create A Virtual Hard Drive Now' option
7. Select VDI option and click 'Next'
8. In the next panel, select 'Dynamically Allocated' and click 'Next'
9. Select the size of the hard drive and click 'Create'
10. Once you have completed the hard disk creation, your virtual machine will show up on the left panel of the main VirtualBox window saying 'Powered Off.' The right panel displays information about it. Double-click the virtual machine

11. A new wizard pops up, where you have to select from a drop-down menu the path to the ISO image of your Linux. The Linux installation process will now start

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